



RISE & SHINE ABA LLC

Empowering children to reach their full potential

WELCOME LETTER & ONBOARDING INSTRUCTIONS

Document v2.0 · Effective May 2026

Date:

Employee Name:

Position / Role:

Start Date:

Dear new team member,

Welcome to Rise & Shine ABA. We are thrilled you've chosen to join our team and to bring your skills to the children and families we serve. Whether you'll be working in homes, schools, telehealth, or community settings, your role is essential to our mission of helping children grow, learn, and shine.

This letter explains exactly what to expect during your first two weeks with us — what you'll receive, what you'll need to complete, and when you'll be cleared to begin client work.

1. Your Employment Classification

You are being hired as a **W-2 employee** of Rise & Shine ABA LLC. This means:

- We withhold federal, state, and FICA taxes from each paycheck.
- We provide workers' compensation, disability, and Paid Family Leave coverage as required by New York law.
- You are eligible for paid sick leave under New York Labor Law.
- You will receive a W-2 form annually for tax filing.

All Rise & Shine ABA direct-care staff (RBTs, BCBA's, Behavior Technicians, and Supervised Fieldwork Students) are classified as W-2 employees. **This is not optional.** It is required by IRS, the New York Department of Labor, BACB, and our payer contracts.

2. Onboarding Timeline

Your onboarding is structured in four windows. Each one has a clear deliverable and a clear owner on our side.

Within 48 hours of accepting your offer — Welcome Call

Your Case Coordinator will call you within 48 hours of your signed offer. This is a brief 15-minute conversation to confirm your start date, walk through the onboarding pack, introduce key contacts, and answer any early questions. Please pick up — this call is part of how we help you start strong.

Days 0–3 — Compliance Pack

You will receive a single e-signature packet from our HR system. **Please complete and sign all documents within 72 hours of receipt.**

The packet contains:

- Federal Form I-9 (Employment Eligibility Verification)
- Federal Form W-4 and New York Form IT-2104 (tax withholding)
- New York Wage Notice (NYS Labor Law §195.1)
- Direct Deposit Authorization
- Background Check Authorization (FCRA-compliant)
- Emergency Contact Form
- Employee Handbook Acknowledgment — covers HIPAA, Confidentiality, NDA, Mandated Reporter, Incident Reporting, Sexual Harassment Prevention, Code of Conduct, and other policies in a single signature event
- New York-required notices: Paid Sick Leave, Workers' Compensation, Disability/PFL, and Sexual Harassment Prevention

You'll also be asked to provide **identity documents for I-9 verification** (see I-9 Instructions for the list of acceptable documents — typically a passport, or a driver's license + Social Security card).

Days 4–10 — Required Trainings

Complete each training and upload the completion certificate to your HR profile:

- **HIPAA Privacy & Security training** (provided through our learning portal)
- **New York Mandated Reporter training** at <https://www.nysmandatedreporter.org> — required within 10 days of start date
- **New York Sexual Harassment Prevention training** (NY-mandated annually for all employees)
- **Rise & Shine internal Clinical Onboarding** — a 4-hour video module on session structure, basic ABA techniques, and our documentation standards
- **Session Note Walkthrough** — a 30-minute live session with your Case Coordinator on the actual EHR system, including writing a mock note start to finish
- **Crisis & Safety Protocol acknowledgment** — what to do in the event of elopement, behavioral emergencies, or injury
- **CPR/First Aid certification** — provide your existing card, or schedule a course through one of our approved providers

Days 10–14 — Activation

- Background check returns clean.
- All certifications uploaded and verified.
- Your supervising BCBA is assigned and you are paired with a senior RBT mentor for your first two weeks.
- You attend a paid orientation session — this is a 2-hour group session for new hires, held weekly.
- You are cleared to be matched with a client. Your Case Coordinator will pair you based on your geography, schedule, language preferences, and availability.

Hard Rule

You cannot begin client services until every item above is complete. This is a strict requirement — for your protection, our clients' safety, and our compliance with state law and payer requirements. Most candidates complete onboarding in 10–14 days. If you encounter delays, contact your Case Coordinator immediately.

3. A Critical Policy You'll See Throughout Your Onboarding

Session note compliance is not optional at Rise & Shine ABA. Every session note must be signed within 24 hours of the session ending.

Sessions without signed notes within 24 hours are non-billable, which means they are unpaid. We don't apply this rule to be punitive — we apply it because unsigned notes violate payer requirements, create audit risk, and undermine the children we serve. You'll see this rule in your offer letter, this Welcome Letter, the Employee Handbook, and your training. We make it visible repeatedly so there's no surprise on your first session.

4. Your Key Contacts

Reach out at any time if you have questions:

- **Your Case Coordinator:** Name and direct contact will be shared during your Welcome Call.
- **HR / Onboarding:** info@riseandshine.nyc · (929) 460-9600
- **Director of Operations:** [Name and contact provided in your Welcome Call]
- **Compliance / HIPAA Officer:** [Name and contact provided in your Welcome Call]

5. What Happens Next

1. Watch your email for the Compliance Pack from our HR system — it should arrive within 24 hours of your signed offer.
2. Pick up the phone for your Welcome Call from your Case Coordinator (within 48 hours).

3. Complete the Compliance Pack within 72 hours.
4. Begin trainings — aim to finish within 10 days.
5. Attend paid orientation.
6. Get cleared. Get matched. Start changing children's lives.

We're glad you're here. We look forward to seeing you shine.

Warm regards,

The Rise & Shine ABA Leadership Team

info@riseandshine.nyc · (929) 460-9600

Acknowledgment of Receipt

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have received and read this Welcome Letter and Onboarding Instructions. I understand my employment classification (W-2), the onboarding timeline, the document deadlines, and the session note compliance rule.

Employee Signature

Date

Print Name

Office Use Only

Reviewed By (HR)

Date
